

Paper 4, Option 4B: Christianity

Topics	What students need to learn	
1 Religious beliefs, values and teachings	1.1	The nature of God as personal and as Creator a) Personal relationship, omnipotence and immutability; ex nihilo, emanation, construction and artistic expression, goodness of creation, stewardship. b) Implications of these teachings about God for an understanding of the self, the meaning and purpose of life, death and the afterlife. c) Interpretations of these teachings and evidence for these views, the challenges of these interpretations and their significance for Christianity, the experience of these roles of God in the life of a Christian. With reference to the ideas of M Buber and Augustine.
	1.2	The Trinity a) Biblical basis for ideas about the Trinity. b) Notions of relation and analogy to understand the Trinity. c) Modern views on the Trinity, their strengths and weaknesses, the impact of these views on the life of a Christian and their significance for Christianity. With reference to the ideas of K Barth and K Rahner.
	1.3	The nature of the Church a) Key concepts of unity, holiness, catholicity and apostolicity. b) Interpretations of these teachings, challenges to these views and their impact on the life of Christian communities and individuals. With reference to the ideas of Cyprian of Carthage and M Luther.
	1.4	Key moral principles a) The concept of Love as the principal Christian value and the basis of all other values and qualities. b) The love of God as revealed in creation, the incarnation and the Trinity as the basis of this value. c) The relationship of all Christian values with the key principle of love.